

PIP for Arthritis – How to Apply in the UK

Complete UK guide to claiming Personal Independence Payment (PIP) for arthritis. Learn eligibility criteria, how to apply, assessment tips, and appeal rights.

By **Living With Arthritis Editorial Team** · Reviewed by **Clinical Advisory Panel** (HCPC-registered physiotherapy & rheumatology nursing input) · 2026-03-01 · livingwitharthritis.org.uk

If arthritis significantly affects your daily life, you may be eligible for **Personal Independence Payment (PIP)** — a UK benefit that helps with the extra costs of living with a long-term health condition. This guide covers everything you need to know about claiming PIP for arthritis.

What Is PIP?

PIP is a non-means-tested benefit for people aged 16 to State Pension age. It has two components:

- **Daily Living** — help with everyday tasks like preparing food, washing, dressing, and managing medications
- **Mobility** — help with getting around, planning journeys, and moving safely

Each component has a standard and enhanced rate. You can receive one or both components.

Am I Eligible?



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You may be eligible if arthritis affects your ability to carry out daily activities or get around. PIP is based on how your condition affects you, not on your diagnosis alone. Key considerations include:

- Pain levels during flare-ups and on average days
- Stiffness that limits your movement, especially in the morning
- Fatigue that prevents you completing tasks
- Need for aids, adaptations, or help from another person
- Variability — even if you have good days, your worst days matter

How to Apply

- Call the DWP on 0800 917 2222 to start your claim

- Complete the PIP2 form — describe your worst days, not your best
 - Gather evidence — GP letters, hospital reports, medication lists
 - Attend the assessment — usually a face-to-face or telephone consultation
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Tips for a Successful Claim



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- Keep a diary of how arthritis affects you over 2-4 weeks before applying
- Describe your worst days and how often they occur
- Mention every joint affected, every medication, and every adaptation you use
- Ask your GP, consultant, or physiotherapist for supporting evidence
- Contact Citizens Advice or a local welfare rights service for free help

If Your Claim Is Refused

Around 70% of PIP decisions are overturned at tribunal. If you disagree with the decision:

- Request a Mandatory Reconsideration within one month
- If still refused, appeal to a First-tier Tribunal
- Get free help from Citizens Advice, local law centres, or disability charities

This guide is for information purposes only and does not constitute legal or financial advice. Contact the DWP or Citizens Advice for personalised guidance.

Q&A

Question: What Is PIP?

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